

LUIS CALDERON



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Affiliation

University of Bonn
Institute for Macroeconomics
and Econometrics
Kaiserplatz 7-9, 53113 Bonn, Germany

Personal

Citizenship: U.S. (German in progress)
Hometown: Miami, FL
Ethnicity: Latino
Languages: English (native),
Spanish (native), German (B1-B2)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, household heterogeneity, monetary and fiscal policy, Bayesian econometrics, functional data analysis, time series

POSITION

University of Bonn

Postdoctoral Researcher, Institute for Macroeconomics and Econometrics

From August 2026

EDUCATION

University of Bonn, Germany

Ph.D. in Economics
M.Sc. in Economics with a specialization in research

Winter 2020 – Summer 2026

University of Bonn, Germany

M.Sc. in Economics

Winter 2018 – Summer 2020

Florida International University, Miami, FL

B.B.A. in Finance
B.A. in Economics, *Minor in Mathematics*

Fall 2013 – Fall 2017

REFERENCES

Christian Bayer
University of Bonn
Institute for Macroeconomics
Christian.Bayer@uni-bonn.de

Moritz Kuhn
University of Mannheim
Department of Economics
mokuhn@uni-mannheim.de

Benjamin Born
University of Bonn
Institute for Macroeconomics
b.born@uni-bonn.de

Farzad Saidi
University of Bonn
Institute for Finance
saidi@uni-bonn.de

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Bonn Graduate School of Economics

CLASS: Coding in Julia and Stata (PhD)
CLASS: Topics in Inequality (BSc)
CLASS: Macroeconomics I (BSc)
WINTER SCHOOL: BASEforHANK (for PhDs and central bankers)

Winter 2021–2025

Summer 2024

Summer 2025, 2026

December 2025

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

University of Bonn (2020 – 2022, 2025), with Christian Bayer, Benjamin Born, Ralph Luetticke, and Moritz Kuhn

University of Mannheim (2024), with Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn

Institute on Behavior and Inequality (briq) (2019 – 2020), with [Leander Heldring](#)

JOB MARKET PAPER (ABSTRACT BELOW)

What Monetary Policy Rules Do, and Where You Can See It

WORKING PAPERS (ABSTRACTS BELOW)

Distributional Dynamics

With Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn. CEPR Discussion Paper 19829. [Link](#).

Not All Oil Supply Shocks are Alike: The Macroeconomic and Distributional Impact of Oil Supply Shocks
May 2026. [Link](#).

Spatial Standard Errors for Several Commonly Used M-estimators

With Leander Heldring. *R&R at the International Journal of Computational Economics and Econometrics*. [Link](#).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Distributional Dynamics: Germany

With Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn

Sectoral Job Levels and Productivity

With Christian Bayer, Moritz Kuhn and See-Yu Chan. [Slides](#).

Monetary Policy According to Data

Household Debt Dilution

The Fiscal Roots of Wealth Inequality: Corporate Concentration and the Eroding Tax Base

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE (EXPANDED)

Department of Macroeconomics, University of Mannheim

January 2024 – September 2024

PIS: Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn

PROJECT: Datawork on Job Levels project

Institute of Macroeconomics and Econometrics, University of Bonn

June 2020 – 2022, 2025

PIS: Christian Bayer, Benjamin Born, Ralph Luetticke, and Moritz Kuhn

PROJECT 1: [Shocks, Frictions, and Inequality in US Business Cycles](#)

PROJECT 2: [Distributional Dynamics](#)

PROJECT 3: [BASEforHANK](#)

MASTER THESIS: [The Effects of Income Uncertainty on Liquidity, Default, and Prosperity](#)

Institute on Behavior & Inequality (briq)

May 2019 – June 2020

PI: [Prof. Leander Heldring](#)

PROJECT 1: [The Cost of State-building: Evidence from Germany](#)

PROJECT 2: [Spatial standard errors for several commonly used M-estimators](#)

MEMBERSHIPS AND ROLES

2024 – present: Member of Collaborative Research Center Transregio 224 “Economic Perspectives on Societal Challenges”

2022 – 2023: Member of RTG 2281 “The Macroeconomics of Inequality”

2021 – 2024: BGSE Student Body Representative

2024 – 2025: Kreisliga Basketball (PG), Volunteer for U18 games

2022 – 2026: Bonner Liga Basketball (PG and Treasurer)

2021 – 2026: NRW Liga Chess Player

**Job Market
Paper**

What Monetary Policy Rules Do, and Where You Can See It

I revisit the role of monetary policy in the transmission of oil supply shocks within a single Bayesian VAR that jointly identifies a Känzig (2021) oil supply news shock and six orthogonal monetary policy shocks. I combine the causal mediation framework of Dufour and Wang (2024), to recover what the Federal Reserve's reaction function loads on, with the sufficient-statistics counterfactual of Caravello, McKay and Wolf (2024), to evaluate *three* alternative rules: a nominal rate peg, strict CPI-inflation targeting, and an optimal dual-mandate rule. Four findings emerge. (i) Aggregate responses are largely insensitive to the rule at short constraint horizons, with the Fed reacting primarily to inflation, the oil price, and demand-side mediators, and negligibly to the oil-market block. (ii) Policy duration is what discriminates the rules at the macro level: held for only a few quarters the three rules look near-identical, but enforced over the full twenty-quarter horizon the rate peg and dual-mandate converge to one another and deliver materially better output, inflation, and unemployment stability than the realized path. (iii) Distributional responses discriminate even at short horizons: the dual-mandate rule tracks the realized Gini paths, while the rate peg and strict inflation targeting both compress income, wealth, and consumption inequality, with strict- π amplifying the realized compression by roughly twenty per cent for income, two-and-a-half-fold for consumption, and threefold for wealth. (iv) The strict- π compression is driven by redistribution toward the bottom of the distribution rather than top-tail destruction. The cross-section, and the duration over which a rule is held, thus discriminate between rules that headline macro aggregates at short horizons cannot.

Working Papers

Distributional Dynamics (with Christian Bayer and Moritz Kuhn). CEPR Discussion Paper 19829. [Link](#).

We develop a new method for deriving high-frequency synthetic distributions of consumption, income, and wealth. Modern theories of macroeconomic dynamics identify the joint distribution of consumption, income, and wealth as a key determinant of aggregate dynamics. Our novel method allows us to study their distributional dynamics over time. The method can incorporate different microdata sources, regardless of their frequency and coverage of variables, to generate high-frequency synthetic distributional data. We extend existing methods by allowing for more flexible data inputs. The core of the method is to treat the distributional data as a time series of functions whose underlying factor structure follows a state-space model, which we estimate using Bayesian techniques. We show that the novel method provides the high-frequency distributional data needed to understand better the dynamics of consumption and its distribution over the business cycle.

Not All Oil Supply Shocks are Alike: The Macroeconomic and Distributional Impact of Oil Supply Shocks. [Link](#).

Oil supply shocks shape U.S. inequality, and *the type of* oil supply shock matters for who bears the cost. In a Bayesian VAR that embeds the joint distribution of U.S. household income, consumption, and wealth alongside a standard oil-market block, sudden production shortfalls (Baumeister and Hamilton, 2019) raise inequality, whereas oil supply news (Känzig, 2021) mostly reduces it. These differences are not visible in the aggregate dynamics, which appear similar across shocks. A causal mediation analysis (Dufour and Wang, 2024) of these aggregate dynamics shows these shocks operate through distinct channels and it is this mechanism wedge, rather than the aggregate footprint, that determines who bears the cost. The analysis shares the view of Kilian and Lewis (2011) that policy responses should depend on the underlying causes of oil price shocks.

Spatial Standard Errors for Several Commonly Used M-estimators (with Leander Heldring). [Link](#).

We provide a unified implementation of existing asymptotic theory that computes Conley-style spatial HAC standard errors for a wide range of commonly used (non-linear) estimators. We cover OLS, logit, probit, Poisson, and negative binomial regressions, as well as the fixed-effects estimators *areg* and *reghdfe*—extending commonly used publicly available routines (currently limited to linear models) to nonlinear M-estimators and fixed-effects workflows. We provide Stata and Python software implementing the procedure.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Seminars & Conferences	2026: Annual Conference of the Central Bank of Brazil (Banco Central do Brasil); North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society (June); CESifo Area Conference on Macro with Micro Data (June, Poster); ICMAIF (University of Crete, May) 2025: CASFI Summer Meeting; BCFM; CRC TR 224 Retreat 2024: Summer Meeting of the SED (Barcelona, Presenter); Banca d'Italia (Rome, Poster); Money Conference (Board of Governors); Center for Advanced Studies in Finance and Inequality (Bonn); Firm Heterogeneity and Macroeconomics (Bonn/Mannheim, 2022–2024) 2023: HANK Conference (Berlin)
Informal Supervision of Master Theses	2025: Marius Trovik (1.0) 2024: Zsigmond Szajbely (1.0) 2023: Luke Liscio (1.0) 2022: Islom Juraev (2.3) 2021: Anna Sanchez (1.7)
Schools & Workshops	Summer Schools: Macroeconomics and Financial Markets (June 2022, Dean Corbae), DSE 2024 Spring Schools: Macroeconomics and Big Data (April 2024, Domenico Giannone, Giorgio Primiceri) Workshops: Empirical Methods in Macroeconomics (May 2024, Christian Wolf)
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